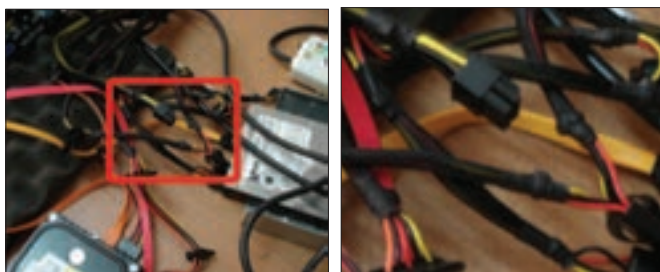


Generally, a smaller sensor produces images that have more noise than those produced by a larger sensor. A smaller sensor comes with its own set of problems such as difficulty in focussing on smaller areas. Further, shaking is exaggerated and despite a high density of cells on the sensor, the image quality is rather low. Try to get as large a sensor as possible.

Be careful not to drool after that 50 MP camera that everyone dreams of. In the right hands, a 6-MP camera can take much better photographs. For publishing purposes, an 8-MP image is normally used. So that's the real deal with megapixels. Now that the biggest myth in digital photography is hopefully busted, there are a few real-world scenarios where that large MP count actually comes into use.



A comparison of detail in a 3.0 MP camera

Many photos, taken off hand, reveal startling details in the background that the photographer might not have noticed while shooting – like a passer-by with a crazy expression behind a group photograph. A high MP count is also useful for shooting far away objects such as aeroplanes, or birds using cameras with a limited optical zoom. This is effectively a digital zoom, but a higher MP count ensures that the resulting image is not terribly grainy – a defect typical to digital zoom.

1.2 Image parameters

Basic image parameters are hue, saturation, contrast, sharpness, tone and colour space. Many digital cameras have settings that play around with these image parameters. These include vividity or beach settings that intensify the colour blue, but you are not given much control over these settings